

The Forgotten You

by

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CHAPTER-1

There is a quiet suffering sweeping across the lives of millions—not loud enough to start a revolution, but deep enough to drown a generation. The youth and corporate workforce stand at a strange crossroads—surrounded by opportunity, yet starved of meaning. Digitally connected, yet existentially adrift. Educated, but not awakened. This isn't just an economic or social crisis. It is a *spiritual disconnection* wearing the mask of modern problems. Let's uncover the real human experience beneath these headlines.

You study for years, earn the degree—and still, doors don't open. Or worse, you get a job that has nothing to do with your inner calling. This disconnect between what you were trained for and what the world offers leaves scars. The mind begins to doubt itself. “*Was I never good enough?*” But the truth is deeper—the system never taught you how to listen to yourSelf. It trained you for a world that no longer exists. This is not your failure. This is a wake-up call to redefine success—not just as employment, but as **alignment** with who you are.

We are taught to remember. But not to reflect. From childhood, you are handed textbooks, exams, and marks. You memorize—but rarely internalize. You obey—but rarely question. And in that process, something more vital is lost—*the joy of curiosity, the art of self-inquiry, the fire to create*. This isn't just about curriculum. This is about a generation that's never been taught how to think, only what to think. You don't need more information. You need **wisdom**—and that begins by learning to listen again.

The soul suffers silently beneath the surface of success. You wake up with the weight of expectations. Perform. Achieve. Be better. Be enough. Be *somebody*. And every scroll through social media becomes a mirror—not of your potential, but of your perceived inadequacy.

Anxiety. Depression. Burnout. Not because you are weak—but because *you are disconnected from your inner sanctuary*. No one taught you how to sit with your emotions. How to breathe through pain. How to be okay with being a *work in progress*.

Mental wellness isn't luxury. It's your birthright. And reclaiming it means remembering: You are not your failures, your image, or your achievements. You are the silence beneath them all. *Running fast in the wrong direction doesn't make it progress.* The world is evolving at lightning speed—AI, green tech, robotics, data science—and yet, the gap widens. What colleges teach and what companies need are now two different planets. And many young minds, full of potential, are left feeling outdated before they even begin.

But deeper still is this question,

“Am I building myself to *fit* a machine... or to **lead** with vision?”

Skills are important. But soul-led skills—those born from self-awareness—are *revolutionary*.

Money is a tool—but for many, it has become the measure of self-worth. Debt. Delay. Dependency. You dream of freedom, but are trapped in a loop of survival. Your goals—a home, a secure life, self-sufficiency—seem distant. And yet, everyone around seems to be moving ahead.

This isn't just about finance. It's about the *internal disempowerment* that comes when you're not in control of your own future. True financial empowerment doesn't just begin with savings—It begins with **self-worth**. Knowing that your value doesn't come from how much you have, but how deeply you know yourself.

We scroll for hours, but never pause to ask: “Who am I, really?” In the age of reels and hashtags, everyone seems to be living their best life. You feel like you're falling behind in a race you never signed up for. You do, you hustle, you grind—and still feel... hollow. This isn't laziness. This isn't confusion. This is a *call from your deeper self*—asking you to stop chasing and start listening. Purpose isn't found outside. It's remembered within.

While the youth suffer in beginning their journey, millions within the corporate world find themselves trapped **midway**. Success outside—burnout inside. Promotions on paper—but no peace in the soul.

Let's listen deeper. *You're always working—even when you're home*. There's no 'off' switch anymore. Evenings become extensions of meetings. Weekends, blurred with emails and targets. But it isn't just about time. It's about **presence**. You're with your family, but your soul is elsewhere.

When work takes away your stillness—it is no longer work. It is spiritual theft. *Tired isn't just physical. It's existential*. The weight of unrealistic expectations, competitive culture, and silent suffering becomes too much. And yet, you smile. You push. You survive.

But what if survival isn't enough anymore? What if your soul is tired of merely coping? Mental health is not weakness. It is a sacred signal—asking you to *return to your center*. *Your potential feels trapped in a glass jar*. Despite your loyalty, hard work, and dreams—you feel unseen. Undervalued. Unfulfilled. You wonder, *"Is this all there is?"* Sometimes, the issue isn't your capability. It's the environment that doesn't nurture authenticity or growth.

Don't shrink to fit in. Expand until you outgrow. *One email. One meeting. Everything changes*. Even the best performers live with quiet fear. Startups crumble. MNCs restructure. AI rises. And in the midst of this unpredictability—your identity feels fragile. But you are not your job title. You are not your monthly CTC. You are the awareness that adapts, that evolves, that *can begin again*.

You have a chair, a cabin, a salary... but where are you in all this? You follow the system. Do the work. Meet the numbers. But something inside whispers:

"This isn't why I came here." We all long for meaningful contribution—not just to work **for** something, but to live **from** something deeper.

And if you've forgotten what that is—it's okay. It's not gone. Just hidden beneath the noise. *What got you here won't take you there*. As the world evolves, many professionals silently ask: *"Do I still matter?"* You fear being replaced—not because you're less capable, but because you've been too busy to upskill, to rediscover, to realign.

But it's never too late to return to the inner fire. Not to compete with the young—but to rise with your own wisdom. You were not born to fit in broken systems. You were born to *remember who you are*, and from that space—to rise. The burning issues of today are not just external disruptions. They are inner calls for awakening. For a new way of working, living, dreaming, and being—not from pressure, but from Presence. To do that you need to be fully aware of your true worth that is many many times more valuable than what you perceive in your life.

Now take three deep breaths and read in stillness the truth that made you possible.

The entire universe is a grand play of two fundamental forces—the Pure Consciousness embodying the Divine Masculine, and the Dynamic Energy representing the Divine Feminine. We call them with different names and I call them Shiva and Shakti respectively. Shiva the divine masculine and Shakti the divine feminine. These two energies are inseparable, intertwined in an eternal dance of existence, much like fire and its heat, the sun and its rays, or the seed and the soil. Shiva, the formless and infinite potential, is the silent witness, the stillness that pervades all. Shakti, in contrast, is the pulsating force that breathes life into creation, setting the cosmos into motion. Together, they form the essence of all that is, shaping the universe in a delicate balance of stillness and movement, presence and expression, infinite vastness and boundless creativity.

The interplay of Shiva (Pure Consciousness) and Shakti (Dynamic Energy) can be understood scientifically through the lens of modern physics and cosmology. The fundamental forces and principles governing the universe resonate deeply with this ancient philosophical concept.

In quantum mechanics, the *observer effect* suggests that the very act of observation influences the behavior of particles. This aligns with Shiva as Pure Consciousness, the silent witness that brings awareness to existence. The *double-slit experiment* demonstrates how subatomic particles exist in a state of potentiality (waveform) until they are observed, at which point they collapse into a definite state. Shiva, in this context, represents the formless potential that remains in a state of pure existence until awareness directs it into manifestation.

Einstein's famous equation $E=mc^2$ shows that energy and matter are interchangeable. This resonates with the concept of Shakti as the dynamic energy that manifests creation. The **Big Bang Theory** states that the universe originated from a singularity, an infinitely dense point of pure potential (Shiva), which then expanded into the cosmos through a tremendous burst of energy (Shakti). The continuous expansion and evolution of the universe reflect Shakti's role in driving creation forward.

In physics, fundamental forces such as **gravity and electromagnetism** exist in a delicate balance, ensuring the stability of galaxies and life itself. Similarly, **matter and antimatter** mirror the dual nature of creation, much like the interplay of Shiva and Shakti. In String Theory, vibrations of tiny strings form different particles, much like the cosmic dance of Shakti, manifesting reality through movement and energy.

The **Second Law of Thermodynamics** states that entropy (disorder) in a system always increases, meaning the universe moves from order to chaos, from stillness to dynamic transformation. Shiva represents the unchanging stillness, while Shakti symbolizes the movement and evolution that drive existence forward.

The structure and movement of our solar system provide a striking example of the interplay between Shiva (Pure Consciousness) and Shakti (Dynamic Energy). The Sun, an almost unchanging, ever-present force at the center, represents Shiva—the formless, stable consciousness that holds the entire system together. The planets, moons, and asteroids, all in

continuous motion around the Sun, represent Shakti—the dynamic, creative energy that gives rise to the cosmic dance of celestial bodies.

Despite the vastness and complexity of our solar system, everything moves in perfect harmony, governed by fundamental physical laws. The force of **gravity**, first described by Newton and later refined by Einstein's General Theory of Relativity, acts as the invisible thread keeping the planets in their orbits. This gravitational pull is akin to the silent presence of Shiva, holding space for everything while remaining unchanged. At the same time, the planets are not static—they move in elliptical orbits, driven by the momentum they gained from the solar system's formation. This continuous movement is the force of Shakti, ensuring the dynamic equilibrium of the cosmos.

The planets do not collide or move randomly because of the precise balance between gravitational attraction (Shiva's stability) and orbital velocity (Shakti's movement). If a planet moved too slowly, it would spiral into the Sun; if it moved too fast, it would escape into deep space. This balance mirrors the ancient idea that Shiva and Shakti are inseparable forces—Shiva provides the stillness, while Shakti ensures motion and transformation.

Even within individual planets, this duality persists. The Earth, for example, has a solid core (symbolizing Shiva's unmoving presence) and an active, ever-changing atmosphere and biosphere (representing Shakti's dynamic nature). Similarly, the interaction between the Sun's solar wind (energy) and Earth's magnetic field (stability) protects life and sustains the planet's delicate balance.

The solar system is a perfect macrocosmic example of how creation operates in a state of harmony, reflecting the deep, ancient wisdom of Shiva and Shakti—order and motion, stillness and energy, consciousness and manifestation, eternally intertwined. From quantum mechanics to cosmology, modern science echoes the wisdom of ancient philosophy. Shiva, the pure awareness, and Shakti, the dynamic force of creation, are not just metaphysical ideas but fundamental principles reflected in the very fabric of reality.

The Origin of All Life

Life is a magnificent cosmic dance, a dynamic interplay of energies embodied by the archetypes of Shiva and Shakti. In the profound tapestry of existence, Shiva represents pure consciousness—still, silent, and unchanging—while Shakti symbolizes energy, movement, and the pulse of creation. This eternal dance of creation, preservation, and destruction is not just a cosmic occurrence; it is the essence of our very being.

The Tandava, Shiva's cosmic dance, embodies the eternal interplay of creation, sustenance, and dissolution. It is the rhythm of existence—where birth and death, creation and destruction, joy and sorrow are in perfect harmony. This dance is reflected in the constant flux of our lives, where we seek balance amidst the chaos.

The Duality Within

Just as the universe is shaped by the harmony of these two fundamental forces, every living being is a microcosm of this divine balance. Within each of us, Shiva represents the stillness of awareness, wisdom, and detachment—the unwavering center from which we observe and understand. Shakti, on the other hand, is the vibrant force of movement, emotions, intuition, and creative expression—the energy that brings thoughts and desires into action. Imagine a musician and his instrument. The musician represents Shiva—still, silent, and potent—while the instrument represents Shakti—vibrant, dynamic, and expressive. Only when the musician plays does the music come to life. Similarly, without Shakti’s energy, Shiva remains unmanifest; without Shiva’s consciousness, Shakti’s dance would be chaotic. This parable teaches that true creation emerges from the union of awareness and action.

A life lived in balance requires both energies to be in harmony. When Shiva dominates without Shakti, there is detachment, emotional coldness, and a loss of motivation, leaving one stagnant and disconnected from the world. When Shakti overpowers Shiva, restlessness, emotional instability, and chaos take over, leading to turbulence and confusion. True fulfillment arises when these energies are nurtured equally—when stillness meets motion, wisdom embraces emotion, and awareness flows into creation.

Just as physics demands equilibrium for stability, the human experience also requires a delicate balance of these energies. Meditation, introspection, and stillness cultivate Shiva, grounding us in awareness and inner peace. Meanwhile, creativity, passion, and movement awaken Shakti, allowing us to engage fully with life’s experiences. Neither can exist in isolation—Shiva without Shakti is unexpressed potential, while Shakti without Shiva is directionless force.

The Eternal Flow of Creation

This divine interplay is woven into the very fabric of existence. The sun and moon, the inhale and exhale of breath, the mind’s logic and emotion, and the body’s stillness and movement—all reflect the rhythmic pulse of Shiva and Shakti. Life itself is a dance of opposites, a sacred union where stability meets transformation, and awareness gives birth to experience. When we recognize this balance within ourselves, we align with the natural flow of the universe, moving effortlessly in harmony with existence and experiencing the boundless bliss of creation.

In the modern world, we are often caught in a relentless pursuit of desires, mistaking fleeting pleasures for true fulfillment. We chase after material wealth, recognition, and sensory indulgence, only to find ourselves entangled in the web of dissatisfaction. Lust, greed, anger, and ego cloud our inner vision, causing an imbalance in the cosmic dance within.

The key to liberation lies in understanding this divine dance. When we embrace the stillness of Shiva and the dynamism of Shakti, we awaken to our true potential. In that realization, we rise above the turbulence of emotions, achieving a state of inner harmony.

Take a moment to reflect—how often do we mistake desire for love or satisfaction for fulfillment? How often are we controlled by impulses rather than guided by wisdom? The dance of Shiva and Shakti calls us to transcend the ego and align ourselves with the flow of the universe.

The human mind is like an ocean—vast, deep, and ever-changing. At times, the surface is calm, reflecting the tranquility of a clear sky. But often, the waves surge with intensity—anger, desire, fear, and doubt crash against the shores of our consciousness. In these moments, we are consumed by inner storms, losing sight of who we truly are.

Just as water can extinguish fire, awareness can quell the inner turmoil. When we learn to observe our thoughts without attachment, we break free from their control. Imagine a flame flickering amidst a storm—strong winds may threaten it, but the flame that burns steadily, undistracted by the tempest, remains. This is the essence of inner mastery—remaining undisturbed by life's challenges.

In the face of adversity, we often react impulsively. Anger rises when we feel wronged, fear grips us in uncertainty, and desire blinds us to wisdom. But when we pause and reflect, we realize these emotions are temporary waves on the ocean's surface. Beneath them lies the stillness of pure awareness.

Ask yourself—how often are your actions driven by impulse rather than conscious choice? Are you the master of your emotions, or are they your master? True confidence arises when we reclaim this inner strength—when the storms of life come, we remain unwavering, anchored in our true essence.

The Five Vices

Lust: The Endless Hunger That Burns Away Peace

Lust is the uncontrolled desire for pleasure, an excessive pull of Shakti's energy without Shiva's wisdom to guide it. It creates a fire that is never satisfied, leading to attachment, obsession, and loss of inner stillness. When ruled by lust, one loses clarity, becoming enslaved to fleeting pleasures rather than experiencing the deeper joys of life. Just as uncontrolled flames consume everything in their path, unchecked desire consumes the mind, leaving it restless and unfulfilled. True harmony is found when passion is balanced with wisdom, when desire is transformed into devotion and love rather than obsession.

“It is lust only, Arjuna, born of contact with the mode of passion, which later transforms into anger and is the all-devouring sinful enemy of this world.”

(kāma eṣa krodha eṣa rajoguṇa-samudbhavaḥ...) (Bhagavad Gita 3.37)

“Just as rain breaks through a poorly thatched house, passion will break through an untrained mind.”-Buddha

(Dhammapada 1:13)

“Desire unchecked is a raging fire. He who conquers it becomes one with the Self.”- Shiv Mahapurana

Greed: The Bottomless Pit That Can Never Be Filled

Greed arises when the mind believes that external possessions can fill an inner void. It is the illusion that more wealth, power, or status will bring lasting happiness. Like a river that constantly erodes its banks in pursuit of the ocean, a greedy mind never finds rest—it is always craving, always unsatisfied. Greed is the imbalance of Shakti's force of accumulation without the grounding presence of Shiva's contentment. When the energy of desire is channeled wisely, it leads to abundance and generosity, but when it spirals into greed, it creates suffering, both within and in the world around us.

“There are three gates leading to this hell—lust, anger, and greed. Every sane man should give these up, for they lead to the degradation of the soul.”-(Bhagavad Gita 16.21)

“The world is afflicted by death and decay. But the wise do not grieve, having realized the nature of the world. Greed brings grief.”

(Dhammapada 170)

“Greed binds the soul to illusion. Release comes only when nothing more is wanted.”-Shiv Mahapurana

Anger: The Destructive Fire That Destroys from Within

Anger is the eruption of unbalanced energy, a force that burns with intensity but lacks control. When provoked, it clouds judgment, making one act without wisdom, harming both oneself and others. Like a storm that disturbs the ocean's surface, anger distorts clarity, leaving behind wreckage and regret. While controlled fire can be a source of warmth and strength, uncontrolled rage consumes everything in its path. True power lies not in suppression but in transformation—when anger is tempered with wisdom, it becomes righteous action rather than blind destruction.

Lord Krishna (Bhagavad Gita 2.63):

“From anger arises delusion; from delusion, loss of memory; from loss of memory, the destruction of intelligence; and from the destruction of intelligence, one perishes.”

Lord Buddha:

“Holding on to anger is like grasping a hot coal with the intent of throwing it at someone else—you are the one who gets burned.”

Shiva's Wisdom:

“When anger rises, silence is your shield. Let it pass like a storm—it shall never touch your soul if you do not invite it.”

Resentment: The Poison That Corrupts the Soul

Resentment is the inability to release past wounds, a stagnant energy that refuses to flow. It is the weight of unhealed pain that shackles the heart, preventing true freedom. Holding onto resentment is like gripping a burning coal, expecting the other person to be hurt—yet it is the one who holds it who suffers most. Just as stagnant water turns toxic, unresolved bitterness poisons the soul, blocking the natural rhythm of healing and renewal. True liberation comes when one embraces forgiveness, not as a weakness, but as the highest expression of inner strength and peace.

Jealousy: The Shadow That Steals Joy

Jealousy arises when one sees another's success or happiness as a threat rather than inspiration. It is the inability to recognize one's own unique path, leading to comparison and insecurity. Like a dark cloud blocking the sun, jealousy obscures one's own light, creating an illusion of lack rather than abundance. It distorts Shakti's energy into restlessness and competition, preventing one from appreciating life's gifts. When transformed, this energy becomes motivation rather than envy, a force that inspires growth rather than resentment.

Ego: The Illusion of Separation

At the heart of all suffering lies the ego—the false sense of identity that separates us from the greater whole. It is the veil that distorts reality, making us believe that we are isolated individuals rather than an interconnected part of existence. In the grand cosmic dance of Shiva and Shakti, the ego is the illusion that we are separate from this divine play, leading to attachment, fear, and suffering.

The ego is not our true self; it is merely a construct of the mind, shaped by experiences, conditioning, and desires. It is the voice that says, "*I am this, I am that*," attaching itself to names, roles, achievements, and opinions. But just as the ocean does not define itself by the waves that rise and fall upon its surface, we are not defined by the fleeting identities we cling to. The ego thrives on division—*me versus you, success versus failure, good versus bad*. It creates boundaries where none exist, preventing us from experiencing the vastness of our true nature.

When the ego dominates, it disrupts the balance of Shiva (pure consciousness) and Shakti (dynamic energy). It traps us in a cycle of attachment and aversion, making us chase after illusions and fear their loss. This imbalance manifests in different ways: When the ego is inflated, it makes us believe we are superior, leading to arrogance and a lack of humility. We become rigid, unable to accept new perspectives or grow beyond our self-imposed limits.

When the ego feels threatened, it creates fear and self-doubt, making us constantly seek validation from others. Instead of recognizing our inherent worth, we become dependent on external approval. The ego constantly compares itself with others, leading to dissatisfaction and resentment. Instead of appreciating our own journey, we become trapped in measuring our worth against others, never feeling enough.

The ego clings to possessions, relationships, and identities, fearing change and loss. It resists the natural flow of life, causing suffering when things do not go as expected. The ego thrives on division, making us identify with labels, opinions, and beliefs. It creates a sense of "otherness," leading to misunderstandings, conflicts, and disharmony in relationships.

Like a river trying to control its own flow, the ego resists the truth that life is ever-changing. It wants certainty, dominance, and permanence in a world where nothing is fixed. But just as the sky is untouched by the passing clouds, our true self remains unshaken beneath the illusions of the mind.

"Conquer the angry man with love. Conquer the ill-natured man with kindness. Conquer the miser with generosity. Conquer the liar with truth."

(Ego is defeated when love and humility are born.) - Lord Buddha

"The self that boasts is blind. The self that dissolves is divine."-(Shiva Sutras)

Restoring Balance: The Path Back to Harmony

These negative emotions arise when the energies of Shiva and Shakti are misaligned—when movement exists without awareness, or when awareness remains detached without expression. The path to harmony is not to suppress these emotions but to understand and transform them. Meditation, self-awareness, and wisdom cultivate Shiva's presence, grounding us in stillness. Creativity, love, and mindful action allow Shakti's energy to flow in a balanced way.

Just as the universe thrives in a delicate balance of forces, so too must the human soul. When we recognize and dissolve these disturbances, we return to our natural state—one of peace, clarity, and divine harmony. In this balance, life is no longer a struggle, but a dance—flowing effortlessly with the rhythm of existence.